The Hidden Influence Society

By
Hrithika Patalay
Master's in International Marketing
Hult International Business School



THE HIDDEN INFLUENCE SOCIETY

SWOT OVERVIEW

STRENGTHS

- *Distinct positioning around “influence decoding”*
- *High student interest in self-branding*
- *Creative, insight-driven leadership*

WEAKNESS

- *Limited awareness and resources*
- *New brand with no legacy*
- *Dependence on word-of-mouth*

OPPORTUNITIES

- ***Rise of the creator economy***
- ***Access to low-cost digital tools***
- ***Growing focus on neurodiversity & inclusion***
- ***Collaboration potential with brands, startups, and marketing agencies for live projects.***

THREATS

- ***Competing clubs or societies***
- ***Short attention spans***
- ***Message dilution if not communicated well***

OBJECTIVES

STRATEGIC

- Increase active membership by 50% in 6 months.
- Through immersive event experiences and club activities.

TACTICAL

- Achieve 40% engagement rate across platforms
- Creating interactive content around club activities and events, behind the scenes, and participations.

HIDDEN INFLUENCE

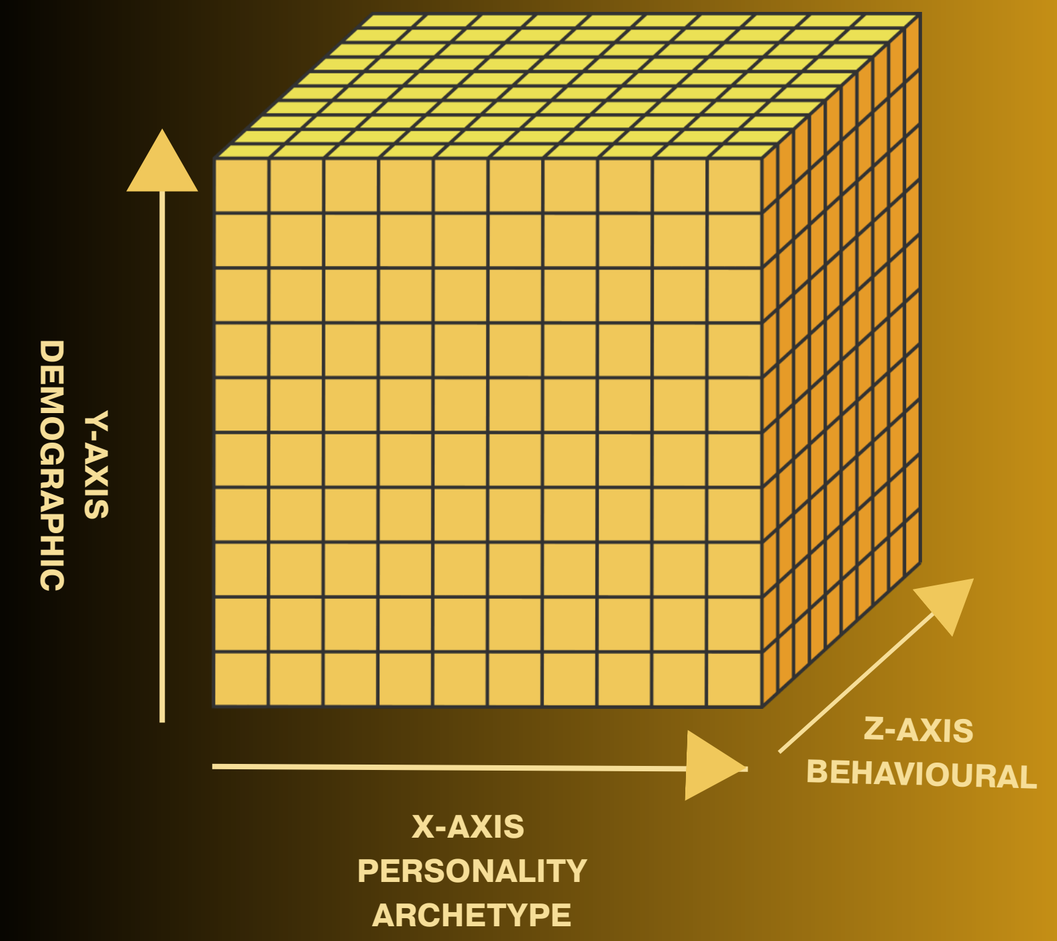
TARGET AUDIENCE

AGE:	**18 - 26 YEARS OLD**
ARCHETYPE	**GROWTH MINDSET & EXPRESSIVE**
BEHAVIOURAL	**EXPRIMENTING THROUGH DIGITAL STORYTELLING & EVENTS**

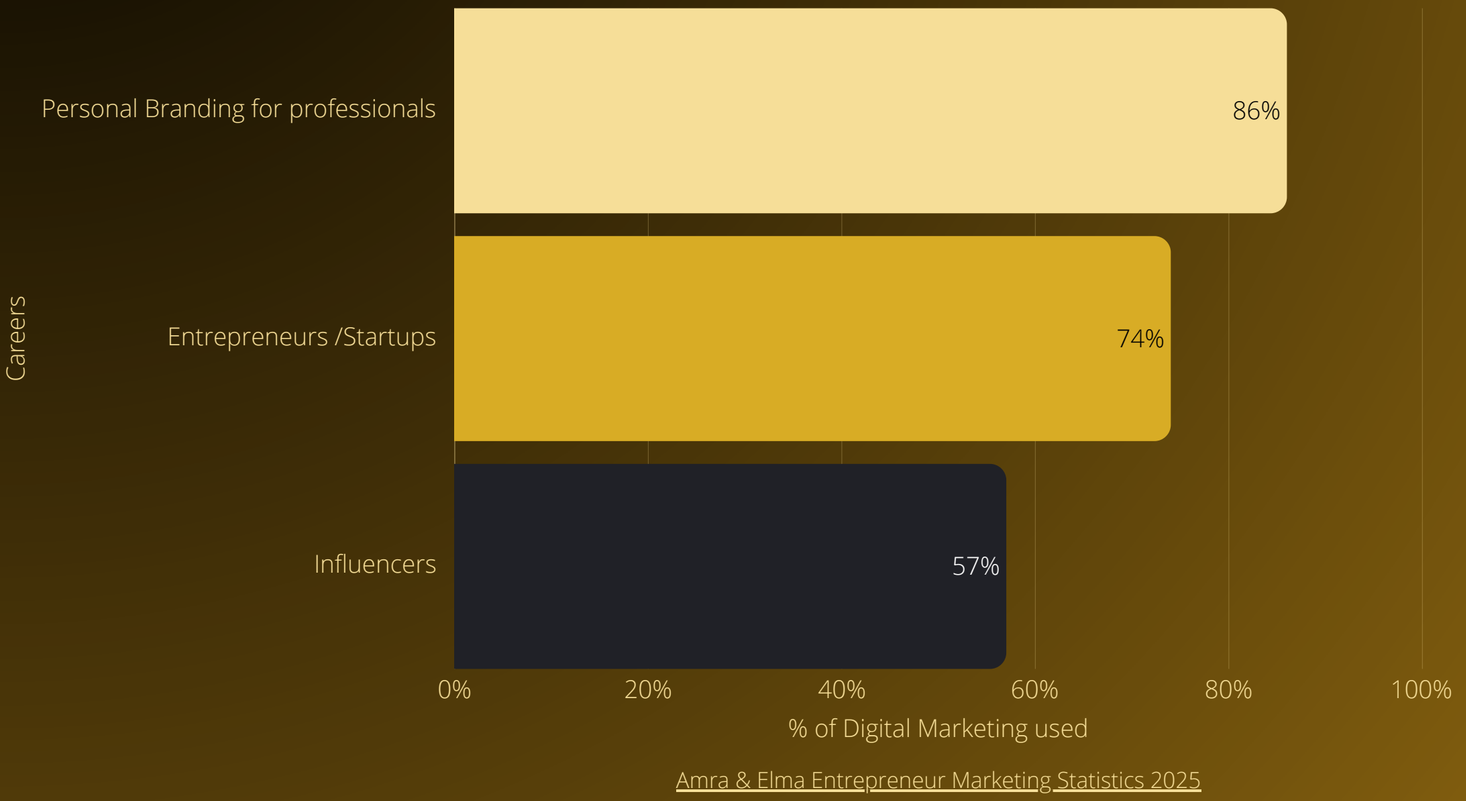
TARGETED SEGMENT:

- Hult undergraduate and postgraduate students passionate about marketing, psychology, entrepreneurship and creativity.
- Students who want to apply influence, strategy, creative psychology to their real-world ideas or projects.

MARKET SEGMENTATION



CUSTOMER INSIGHTS



Amra & Elma Entrepreneur Marketing Statistics 2025

Aspiring influencers: 57% of Gen Z want to be influencers as it drives follower growth and engagement.

Professionals: Personal branding powered by digital strategies boosts employability and career advancement, almost 86% of professionals see its importance.

Startups/Entrepreneurs: Digital marketing fuels customer acquisition and accelerates growth and 74% of startups and entrepreneurs use influencer-driven marketing.

MarketinginMotionWalks

Campaign Concept

An integrated campaign combining social storytelling, digital zines, and experiential marketing to showcase how influence works in daily life.



#InfluenceDecoded

Execution

- **Digital Zines :** Monthly digital magazines summarizing activities, experiments, and learnings.
- **Social Media Activation :** Encourages members to post insights, experiences from the events.
- **Outcome:** Builds a content archive and digital footprint of the club's creativity and impact.

CONTENT IS KING



#InfludenceDecoded

Creating a Three-tier Ecosystem



Engage

Short-form, high-impact content (reels, carousels, stories). Instagram builds engagement through campaigns, quick insights, and event highlights.

Educate

Long-form content hub for marketing reflections, campaign analyses, and featured student work on Substack. Members can post assignments or activity reports to build credibility.

Establish

Showcase participation, achievements, and leadership roles. Linkedin can build professional visibility, networking opportunities, and industry proof of skill.

SYNERGY

Tying it all together



Collaborations

Partner with other Hult clubs (Entrepreneurship, Consulting, Women in Business) to co-host events and expand reach.



Industry Integration

Invite guest speakers, marketing professionals, and startup founders to judge events, mentor students, or collaborate on live projects.



Content-Led Community

Turn student work into shareable case studies that spotlight individual talent while strengthening the club’s brand equity.

CUSTOMER JOURNEY

Awarness

Discover club through posters or online.

Consideration

Attend club fair, word of mouth.

Decision

Sign up or attend first event.

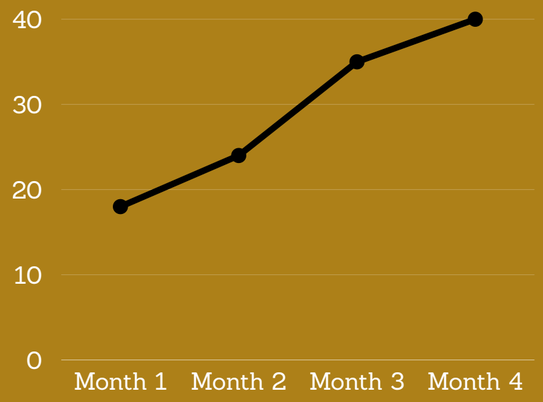
Engagement

Participate in workshops/activites

Advocacy

Share with peers, alumni network

KPI'S



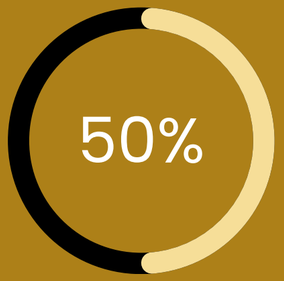
40% Engagement Rate across platforms



3 Cross-University collaborations



2 Employer engagements or partnerships



50% Active Members in 6 months



+25% Substack subscribers



PERFORMANCE TRACKING

01 **DIGITAL ANALYTICS:** ENGAGEMENT, REACH, AND CONVERSION TRACKING VIA PLATFORM INSIGHTS.

02 **EVENT DATA:** ATTENDANCE RATES AND PARTICIPATION SURVEYS.

03 **CONTENT METRICS:** READ TIME ON SUBSTACK, SHARES, AND REPOSTS.

04 **FEEDBACK LOOPS:** QUARTERLY MEMBER FEEDBACK SESSIONS AND FOCUS GROUPS TO REFINE STRATEGY.

Influence isn’t just power - it’s perception.

Thank you!

for decoding it with me.

Follow:
@hiddeninfluencesociety

Read:
hiddeninfluence.substack.com

Connect:
LinkedIn — The Hidden Influence Society

REFERENCES

- Amra & Elma. (2025, September 14). Top 20 market marketing statistics 2025. https://www.amraandelma.com/market-marketing-statistics/
- Amra & Elma. (2025). Best employer branding statistics 2025. https://www.amraandelma.com/employer-branding-statistics/
- Avery, J., & Greenwald, R. (2023). A new approach to building your personal brand: How to communicate your value. Harvard Business Review, 101(3), 147–151. https://www.hbs.edu/faculty/Pages/item.aspx?num=63629
- Backlinko. (2025). Substack user and revenue statistics (2025). https://backlinko.com/substack-users Backlinko
- Dennison, K. (2022, November 28). Why personal branding is important and how to build yours. Forbes. https://www.forbes.com/sites/karadennison/2022/11/28/why-personal-branding-is-important-and-how-to-build-yours/
- HR Review. (2024, November 22). How Gen Z workers use social media to shape career paths. HR Review. https://hrreview.co.uk/hr-news/recruitment/how-gen-z-workers-use-social-media-to-shape-career-paths/378012HRreview | HR News, Opinion & Advice
- Huzzle. (2024). 50+ statistics on the impact of student societies (2024). Huzzle Blog. https://www.huzzle.com/blog/50-statistics-on-the-impact-of-student-societies-2024
- Later. (2025). Gen Z stats & trends: How to market to Gen Z in 2025. Later Blog. https://later.com/blog/gen-z-trends/Later
- Morning Consult. (2024, September 30). Influencers are becoming a go-to authority for most Gen Zers. https://pro.morningconsult.com/analysis/influencers-content-creators-evolving-power-2024
- Sprout Social. (2025). 28 must-know LinkedIn statistics for marketers in 2025. https://sproutsocial.com/insights/linkedin-statistics/ Sprout Social
- Sprout Social. (2024). Gen Z social media trends & usage. SproutSocial Insights. https://sproutsocial.com/insights/gen-z-social-media/ Sprout Social

Appendices

Executive summary

The Hidden Influence Society is a student-led brand and creative think tank that functions like a micro marketing consultancy — helping students and creators decode influence through digital storytelling, psychology, and brand experiences.

Our purpose is to help members understand why people buy, click, and connect — transforming this insight into creative campaigns that make their projects and ideas more successful.





Situational Analysis

The opportunity lies in embracing diversity and neurodiversity as a creative lens for marketing — showing how influence is experienced differently across minds and cultures

Diversity drives creativity — London’s multicultural and neurodiverse ecosystem offers endless inspiration for inclusive marketing.